

RAJWANT RAWAT

ANDAMAN AND NICOBAR ISLANDS
TOWARDS A CLIMATE RESILIENT FUTURE

SUSTAINING THE ANDAMANS

The India Today Conclave served as the platform for unveiling a report titled 'Towards a Climate Resilient Future: Strategies for Andaman and Nicobar Islands', published by PwC India. Released by Dr Keshav Chandra, former chief secretary of A&N Islands, the report highlights three key areas: the need to balance development goals with environmental safeguards; essential adaptation and mitigation strategies; and challenges in financing these measures without putting a burden on the local communities.

In his opening remarks, Sanjeev Krishan, chairman of PwC India, stressed the significance of the growth versus environment debate, particularly "at a time when climate change seems to be getting less and less importance globally". Dr Chandra, too, underscored the urgency to find a "solution". "We need to take care of all development aspects," he concluded during his presentation.



SANJEEV KRISHAN
Chairman, PwC India



KESHAV CHANDRA
Former Chief Secretary, Andaman & Nicobar Islands

A subsequent panel discussion focused on the climate risks confronting the region, including mangrove degradation, rising temperatures and water stress. Experts emphasised the need for systematic risk assessment, adaptation strategies, private sector engagement, sustainable tourism and leveraging the region's blue economy potential. ■

> **Financing is a big, big issue everywhere**.... The problem with the companies doing CSR is that they don't want to go out five kilometres away from their factory
> -Anish Chatterjee

> I consider **climate change as a developmental problem.** It emerges from the forces of development precisely because of our unbridled human ambition
> -Nilanjan Ghosh

> The first thing we've seen [in A&N Islands] is that the **mangrove cover is retreating**.... The other issues are submergence of land, and monoculture
> -Madhura Mittal

> **You can't be resilient on your own; it's a collective thing.** You can't protect your factory if you can't protect the neighbourhood
> -Ankit Gupta